

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Board: 3
Dealer: **West**

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 5
 ♥ J 10 6 5 3 2
 ♦ Q J 9
 ♣ A

♠ K 9 2
 ♥ A K 8 7 4
 ♦ K 10 7
 ♣ 10 8



♠ A 7 4 3
 ♥ Q
 ♦ A 6 4 2
 ♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J 10 6
 ♥ 9
 ♦ 8 5 3
 ♣ K Q J 9 5 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Dbl

2 ♣¹

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

North opens 1 ♥ and East Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2 ♣ without fear that North will think you have a strong hand. North also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4
 ♥ K Q 7
 ♦ K 7 3
 ♣ -

♠ 10 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A 9

♣ Q 8 7 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 2

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 8 6 2

♣ A K J

♠ 5

♥ A 10 6 5 3

♦ 10 5 4

♣ 10 9 5 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠	

All Pass

would have shown one Ace and West wouldn't know what to do next. She might have figured the odds favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. East responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. East agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). East bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

East's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. West realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that West did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces, East

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 10 9
♣ 8 6 4 2

♠ 7 4

♥ Q 7 3

♦ A K J 7 3

♣ K J 9



♠ K 5 3

♥ 10 5

♦ 8 6 5 4

♣ A Q 7 3

♠ A J 10 8 2

♥ A K 8 2

♦ Q 2

♣ 10 5

South opens 1♠. You respond 2♦, a 2/1 force to game. Partner rebids 2♥, showing a 4-card side suit.

You don't have 4♥s, nor do you have have 3♠s. You do, however, have stoppers in ♣s so you bid 2NT. South happily says 3NT.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			